

Robert Kotcher

Y Combinator alumni | Carnegie Mellon graduate | viral app founder | 2 exits

Education

Carnegie Mellon University '12
BXA Computer Science, Arts

AlphaLab Accelerator '12
with Tunessence (acquired)

Projects

codesurf.io
Review tool helped team 2x review velocity and 3.5x understanding

Cat-astrophe prevention unit
I built a robot to spray my cat when he gets on the counter.

Research

Timing attacks using CSS filters
51 citations

OAuth Demystified for Mobile Application developers
180 citations

Contact

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Professional experience

Founder, engineer @ inflightsimulator.com
(August 2026 – present)

Inflight Simulator went viral, reaching 60,000 flights within days of release.

Inflight Simulator lets people explore the world as an airline passenger, choosing destinations and collecting country flags as they complete virtual flights.

Technical skills required included Three.js, Node.js, shadow mapping, geometry reduction, scene culling, frustum streaming, and character rigging.

#Three.js #Node.js #3DGraphics #PerformanceOptimization #CharacterRigging

Founding engineer, pod lead @ solosuit.com (2024 – present)

As a founding engineer at SoloSuit (Y Combinator, W21), I helped build a debt resolution platform serving 200,000+ Americans and protecting $2.7 billion in claimed debt.

I identified growth opportunities across SoloSettle's settlement funnel and led dozens of A/B tests, growing monthly settlement volume 20x in 20 months.

I identified friction in the settlement-offer workflow, chose what to build, and shipped an experiment that increased the offer send rate from 8% to 37%.

I lead a pod of 3–6 engineers and own delivery from technical planning through production. I build and maintain core features in TypeScript, Ruby on Rails, and PostgreSQL, supporting a 12,000+ spec test suite.

#TypeScript #RubyOnRails #PostgreSQL #ABTesting #TechnicalLeadership

Product R&D @ Codecov (2020 – 2022)

Codecov was acquired by Sentry in 2022. I researched and built new products in JavaScript and Jest that were later handed off to the engineering team. My testing tool was one of the reasons for the acquisition.

#JavaScript #Jest #ProductResearch #TestAutomation

Lead Software Engineer @ Synthesis AI (2020 – 2023)

As a founding engineer, I built most of Synthesis AI's data pipelines from the ground up using Go (Golang) and Kubernetes. I maintained AWS infrastructure, Docker containers, and a Go API.

#Go #Kubernetes #Docker #AWS #DataPipelines

Software Engineer @ Hippo Education (2017 – 2019)

Built an educational dashboard and content management system for doctors using React.js and a Python backend. Worked on internal tooling and an ETL pipeline for podcast processing.

#React #Python #ContentManagement #InternalTools #ETL

Software Engineer @ expii.com (2015 – 2017)

Built Expii's responsive learning-content editor in React.js, CSS, and Flexbox, supporting image, diagram, multiple-choice, text, and video blocks with pixel-perfect implementation of professional designs. The platform used a Python/Flask backend on AWS.

#React #Python #CSS #Flexbox #Flask #ResponsiveDesign

Software Engineer @ NASA (2013 – 2015)

I developed Java software for an ADS-B sense-and-avoid system that was licensed to Vigilant Aerospace.

#Java #ADSB #CollisionAvoidance

Full Stack Engineer @ Tunessence (April 2012 – June 2014)

I was the first hire at Tunessence, a guitar-teaching startup acquired by music publisher Hal Leonard. I worked across the stack using Python and JavaScript.

#Python #JavaScript #FullStackDevelopment

Technical experience

Frontend

React.js	10 years
CSS	10 years
HTML5	10 years
TypeScript	8 years

Backend

Python	10 years
Node.js	10 years
Java	6 years

Infrastructure

AWS	8 years
Docker	7 years
Kubernetes	3 years